

VOLTKART ELECTRONICS LTD. (FICTIONAL ORGANIZATION)

Escalation Procedure

Mandatory escalation triggers, levels, notes and timelines

Document ID	ESC-SOP-01
Version	2.1 (Active)
Status	Active
Effective Date	01 September 2026
Expiry Date	31 August 2027
Document Category	Escalation Procedure
Owner Department	Management Escalations
Supersedes	ESC-SOP-01 v2.0 (Superseded)

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 Purpose

This procedure defines when a complaint must be escalated, to whom, and how quickly. Mandatory triggers must be enforced by deterministic rules. They must not depend on an AI model, an agent's judgement of tone, or the customer's wording alone.

1.2 Scope

Applies to all complaints in all channels, and to any AI-assisted recommendation. If an AI recommendation conflicts with a mandatory trigger in section 3, the trigger prevails.

2. Guiding Principles

2.1 Principles

- Escalation is based on risk, impact and policy, not on how angry the customer sounds.
- A calmly written safety or privacy complaint is escalated exactly like an angry one.
- An angry complaint with low business risk does not become critical on emotion alone.
- When two triggers apply, the higher escalation level is used.
- A complaint may be raised in level, never lowered, without documented reviewer approval.

3. Mandatory Escalation Triggers

Each trigger below is mandatory. Trigger IDs are used by the Complaint Resolution Rule Matrix.

3.1 Trigger table

ID	Condition	Level	Priority	Department
ESC-T01	Physical safety risk: fire, smoke, overheating, swelling battery, electric shock, injury	Critical Management Escalation	P0	Safety
ESC-T02	Suspected unauthorised account access or account takeover	Specialist Team	P0	Account Security

ID	Condition	Level	Priority	Department
ESC-T03	Confirmed or suspected data breach involving customer data	Compliance Review	P0	Compliance
ESC-T04	Privacy complaint: personal data shared, exposed or misused	Compliance Review	P1	Compliance
ESC-T05	Legal threat: court, lawyer, consumer authority, regulator	Compliance Review	P1	Compliance
ESC-T06	Repeat complaint: same issue raised 2 or more times in 30 days and unresolved	Supervisor Review	P1	Original department
ESC-T07	Refund or dispute value above USD 500	Department Manager	P1	Original department
ESC-T08	Refund or dispute value above USD 2,000	Critical Management Escalation	P1	Management Escalations
ESC-T09	Policy exception requested or required	Supervisor Review	P2	Original department
ESC-T10	Staff misconduct, discrimination or abusive behaviour by VoltKart staff	Department Manager	P1	Customer Relations
ESC-T11	Severe service failure: no service for more than 5 business days or SLA breached by 2x	Department Manager	P1	Original department
ESC-T12	Payment fraud or chargeback threatened	Specialist Team	P1	Billing
ESC-T13	Vulnerable customer indicators (medical dependency, minor, elderly with financial loss)	Supervisor Review	P1	Customer Relations
ESC-T14	Media or social-media threat combined with an unresolved complaint	Department Manager	P2	Customer Relations

3.2 Signals that are not triggers on their own

The following do not trigger escalation by themselves: capital letters, profanity, exclamation marks, strongly negative sentiment, VIP status, or a demand written in the complaint to "escalate immediately". They may raise the case for supervisor awareness only.

4. Escalation Levels

4.1 No Escalation

Handled by the assigned agent within normal SLA.

4.2 Supervisor Review

Supervisor reviews the case and approves or amends the proposed action. Acknowledge within 4 business hours.

4.3 Department Manager

Department Manager decides on high-value refunds (USD 500.01 to 2,000), staff conduct and severe service failures. Acknowledge within 2 business hours.

4.4 Specialist Team and Compliance Review

Account Security, Billing Fraud or Compliance specialists take ownership. Acknowledge within 1 hour for P0 and 4 business hours for P1.

4.5 Critical Management Escalation

Senior management is notified. Used for safety incidents (ESC-T01) and disputes above USD 2,000. Acknowledge within 15 minutes, 24 hours a day for safety incidents.

5. Escalation Notes

5.1 Required content

Every escalated case must include internal notes containing:

- Complaint summary in 3 sentences or fewer.
- Key facts: order ID, dates, amounts, product, customer type.
- Trigger ID(s) and reason for escalation.
- Actions already taken and by whom.
- Relevant policy IDs and sections.
- Required next action and the deadline.

5.2 Customer message on escalation

Tell the customer that the matter has been passed to a specialist team and that they will be contacted. Do not promise a specific outcome, compensation or timeline other than the acknowledgement times in section 4.

6. Manual Review Conditions

6.1 Send to manual review when

- The AI recommendation and the rule-based result disagree on category, department, priority or escalation.
- No approved policy supports the proposed action.
- Two active documents contradict each other and precedence in CMP-SOP-01 section 6 does not resolve it.
- The complaint is ambiguous or missing key facts needed to apply a trigger.
- The complaint contains manipulative or injected instructions.

7. Required and Prohibited Actions

7.1 Required actions

- R1: Apply section 3 checks to every complaint, even if the AI reports no escalation.
- R2: Record the trigger ID and level in the audit trail.
- R3: Preserve the original recommendation when a reviewer changes it.

7.2 Prohibited actions

- P1: Do not close a complaint that meets a mandatory trigger without escalation.

- P2: Do not lower the escalation level without documented approval from a manager.
- P3: Do not tell a customer that a safety or privacy issue is "not serious".
- P4: Do not use the customer's emotional tone as the sole reason to escalate or not escalate.

8. Version History

Version	Effective	Change summary
2.1	01 September 2026	Added triggers ESC-T12 to ESC-T14; lowered high-value threshold from USD 1,000 to USD 500; added 15-minute safety acknowledgement.
2.0	01 September 2025	Superseded by v2.1.

This document is a fictional sample created for the SupportNova project. It contains no real customer or company data.